

Unit 4: Internet Fundamentals

- **What is Internet**

- **What it is:** A massive, global network that connects millions of smaller computer networks together.
- **Study Tip:** Think of the Internet as the physical infrastructure—the massive cables running under the ocean and the satellites in space that allow devices across the world to talk to each other.

- **History of Internet**

- **What it is:** The Internet didn't start as a public tool. It began in the late 1960s as a US military project called **ARPANET** so researchers could share data even if parts of the network were destroyed.

- **WWW (World Wide Web)**

- **What it is:** The collection of digital pages and content that you view online.
- **Study Tip:** *Crucial difference!* The Internet is the "road system" (the connection), while the WWW is the "shops and houses" (the websites) built alongside those roads. You use the Internet to access the Web.

- **Web Browser**

- **What it is:** The application software installed on your computer or phone that allows you to view and interact with the World Wide Web.
- **Examples:** Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, and Apple Safari.

- **Search Engine**

- **What it is:** A specialized website designed to help you find information across the entire World Wide Web based on keywords you type in.
- **Study Tip:** Don't confuse this with a browser! You open a *Web Browser* (like Chrome) first, and then you navigate to a *Search Engine* (like Google.com or Bing.com) to search for things.

- **URL (Uniform Resource Locator)**

- **What it is:** The exact, unique web address of a specific page or file on the Internet.
- **Study Tip:** Just like every house in the real world has a unique street address so the postman can find it, every single web page has a unique URL (e.g., <https://www.example.com/notes>).

- **Hyperlink**

- **What it is:** A clickable piece of text, image, or button on a webpage that jumps you to a new page or a different section of the same page.
- **How to remember it:** It's the "link" that connects the "web" together. When your mouse pointer turns into a little hand icon, you are hovering over a hyperlink.